The `-v "$PWD":/usr/src/myapp` switch tells the Docker server to mount our current working directory into the container using the path `/usr/src/myapp`. This means that if our current path contains the file `hello.php` then the container will be able to read it via `/usr/src/myapp/hello.php`.

To make this command even more useful, we can change the working directory of the PHP process inside the container, and add a network port mapping while we're at it. In fact let's cover all our bases and put it the container into interactive mode, and add a command alias for easy invocation.

```
$ alias docker-php='docker run -it --rm --net=host -p 8000:8000 -v "$PWD":/
usr/src/myapp -w /usr/src/myapp php:8.4-cli php'
```

The bash command above creates an alias of `docker-php` which invokes `docker run` in interactive mode, with automatic removal of the container when it's done (more on this in a moment), mapping the host TCP 8000 port to the container's TCP 8000 port, with a volume mount of host current working directory to container `/usr/src/myapp`, and changes the working directory of the container's PHP process to `/usr/src/myapp`. It also specifies `--net=host` so the container is able to use the host's network directly, which will be useful in later examples when we launch other services in containers. On some image/system combinations you might see a warning like this in the first line of output…

```
WARNING: Published ports are discarded when using host network mode
```

… but it's nothing we need to worry about for the purposes of this book, this isn't a message from PHP. If you've chosen not to install PHP on your host system and prefer to keep everything containerized (which is exactly how I wrote this book), you can use an alias in lieu of an actual PHP binary. Wherever you see an example in this book like `php ...`, just substitute `docker-php ...` or any alias you like. To make an alias a permanent feature of your shell environment, add the alias command to the end of your shell configuration file in your home directory (`~/.bashrc` for bash, `~/.zshrc` for zsh and so on). Otherwise this alias is only available in the shell you ran the command in, and will vanish once that shell terminates.

Now that we have the `docker-php` alias in place we can do the following:

```
$ docker-php ./hello.php
hello world
```